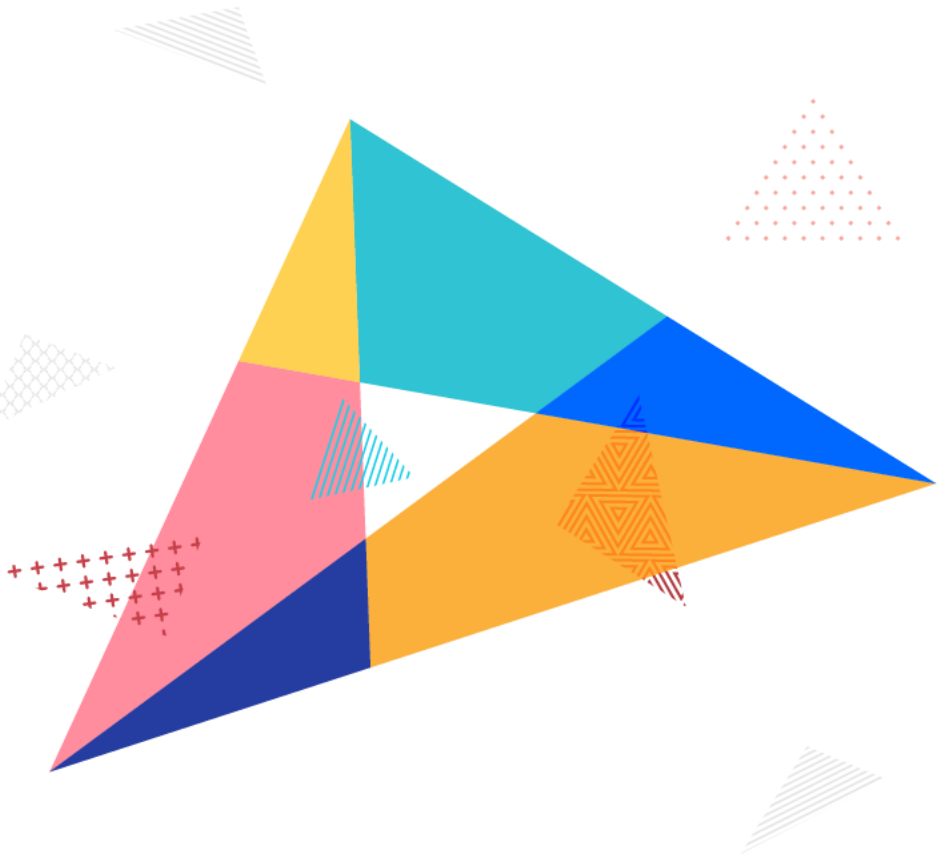
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Leadership - Customised Approach for Individuals

Improving Communication Across Diverse Personalities and Work Styles

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Agenda

1	Understanding People: personality, behaviour and work styles	Do you understand yourself, why people behave the way they do, and how this impacts their work styles?
2	Self- Awareness and Relationship Management	Allows Leaders to build trust, make better decisions and foster high-performing teams
3	Adapting Your Communication for Diverse Personalities	Do people hear you or do they listen? It's not about changing who you are, but building understanding, trust and influence
4	Effective Communication, Motivation and the ERG Theory	Identifying how effective communication can motivate different work styles and using the ERG theory to build engagement



Understanding People: Personality, Behaviour and Work Styles

How Well Do I Know Myself?





Have you ever looked in the mirror and asked yourself?

- *Who am I?*
- *Do others see me the way I see myself?*
- *Why do other people behave/think differently from me?*

Leading Others - Understanding Behaviour

Factors that Influence Individual Behaviour – Personality:

The Person:

- personality, skills, attributes, values, ethics

The Environment:

- work, group, job, characteristics, organisation, personal life

The Situation:

- strong and weak situations

What is common to all individuals:

- survival and success



Leading Others - Understanding Behaviour

Psychological Factors:

Personality and temperament:

- Internal traits like shyness, openness, or an ***internal locus of control*** create consistent patterns in how people think and respond

Cognition and perception:

- How people process memories, make decisions, and use ***mental shortcuts*** dictates their interpretation of events

Emotions and motivation:

- Feelings like ***fear, joy, or anger*** push people to overcome obstacles or react defensively



Leading Others - Understanding Behaviour

Social and Environmental Factors:

Culture and Norms

- ***Societal rules, group memberships, and values*** shape what actions people view as acceptable or expected.

Immediate surroundings:

- Physical settings (***like noisy or crowded spaces***) and the presence of other people heavily influence compliance, conformity, and general conduct.

Life experiences:

- Past events, family background, and childhood upbringing create ***deep-seated beliefs that guide adult choices***, often without conscious awareness



Cultivating Trust through Behaviour

- Trust is the positive expectation that another will not act opportunistically (Robbins:336)
- It is a history-dependent process - ***Authenticity***



Key dimensions are:

- integrity – without which other dimensions are meaningless
- competence
- consistency
- loyalty
- openness

Behaviour and Diverse Work Styles

The Driver / Driven:
- Results-focused
- Direct
- Decisive
- Action-oriented





The Amiable
- Relationship-focused
- Supportive
- Collaborative
- Patient

The Analytical
- Detailed-oriented
- Logical
- Data-driven
- Risk-conscious





The Expressive
- Visionary
- Enthusiastic
- Creative
- Big Picture Thinker

Strategies For Managing Diverse Personalities

Embrace Flexibility:

- Effective Leadership is not a one size fits all. Adapt your approach to fit the needs of your team. Some employees ***may prefer detailed instructions, while others thrive with creative freedom;*** adjust your communication and management style accordingly.

Foster open Communication:

- Create an environment where team members feel comfortable expressing themselves. Hold regular one-on-one meetings to check in on their ***needs, goals and challenges***. This not only ***builds trust*** but also helps you understand ***what motivates them***



Strategies For Managing Diverse Personalities

Leverage Strengths

- Assign tasks based on your team's strengths; the analytical thinker might excel in project planning, while the social butterfly could lead client presentations. ***Matching tasks to skills increases efficiency and job satisfaction***.

Address Conflicts Proactively

- Personality differences can sometimes lead to misunderstandings or disagreements. As a leader, intervene early by encouraging open dialogue and helping team members find common ground. Approach conflicts ***with empathy and focus on shared goals*** and solutions, rather than blame.



Strategies For Managing Diverse Personalities

Provide Growth Opportunities

- Recognise the potential in each individual and offer opportunities for ***personal and professional development.*** This might include training, mentorship, or ‘stretch’ assignments ***(self-efficacy***) that challenge them to grow beyond their comfort zone.



Case Study – Generational Leadership Change in Vietnam

From Old Bamboo to New Shoots: Leadership Competencies for Vietnam's Generation Z Lotus Leaders.

- 100 Gen Z males and 100 Gen Z females
- Collectivism, Harmony, and Community Orientation – *Convergent*
- Hierarchy, Power Distance, and Voice Constraints – *Convergent*
- Global Exposure and Cultural Hybridisation – ***Divergent***
- Human-Centric Leadership *Relational* – ***Divergent***
- Adaptability, Learning and Change Orientation *Relational* – ***Divergent***
- Purpose, Vision and National Development - *Convergent*
- Leadership Identity, Aspiration and Self-Leadership - ***Divergent***





Self Awareness and Relationship Management

Emotional Intelligence

Understanding You – Understanding Others

Leading Self:

- Successful leaders know their strengths and weaknesses. They ***continually seek personal development and learn new skills*** or by empowering others and using their skills

Leading Others:

- Leaders know they need other people. ***Sometimes you lead and other times you follow.*** Leaders develop other leaders

Leading Organisations:

- Leadership means being visionary and having the ***ability to influence and motivate others to achieve organisational goals.***





Self-Awareness

- **Self-Awareness** is ***imperative in leadership contexts.***

- You need to be thoughtful about the experience that you want people to have of you as a leader. A key tenet of leadership is the ***capability for growth and learning.***

- You will likely encounter situations as a leader that require you to learn and grow at the very moment others expect you to be an authority. ***You will inevitably make mistakes in your leadership journey. Do not be embarrassed to do what it takes to develop as a leader.***

Developing Leadership Attributes: Self and Social Awareness

Self Awareness:
- the ability to understand your own emotions and their effects

Social Awareness:
- empathy
- remember not everyone values or does things in the same way as you

We recognise the impact we have on others and how others see us



Developing Leadership Attributes: Self and Social Management

Self-Management:

- achievement orientation – the concern of working towards standards of excellence, which also assists you in taking the initiative and seek out new opportunities
- adaptability
- ***emotional self-control - regulation***
- positive outlook

Social Management:

- the ability to understand the 'power' relationships in one's own group or organisation to build team bonds and influence change – ***regulate the halo effect and build leadership silos***



Relationship Management

- Conflict Management
- Coaching and Mentoring
- Power and Influence ***(Expert and Referent)***
- Inspirational Leadership ***(Lead by bringing out the best in people)***
- Teamwork
- Pattern Recognition ***(Systems and Critical Thinking – Problem Solving)***



Self-Awareness and Relationship Management



Social awareness and self-management are key levers in relationship management. To be effective with others, you need to have a handle on your emotions and be able to channel them in an effective way.

Emotional Intelligence – Self-Assessment Questionnaire





Key Points – Self-Awareness and Relationship Management



Develop your ***self-leadership, self-awareness, and relationship management.*** What will be ***YOUR leadership legacy?***



Build trust, clear communication, and emotional intelligence for enhanced engagement and long-term partnerships



Adapting Your Communication for Diverse Personalities

Adapting Communication For Diverse Personalities

Communication across diverse personalities requires adapting your approach to how different people process information, express themselves, and interact:

Introverts vs. Extroverts:

- Extroverts process thoughts out loud and prefer rapid interaction, while introverts need quiet time to reflect before responding

Task-Oriented vs. People-Oriented:

- Some people focus strictly on facts, data, and bottom lines, while others prioritise relationships, feelings, and team harmony. Balance your message with both data and personal warmth.

Avoid Negative Labelling:

- Don’t view different communication styles as ***difficult*** or ***argumentative.***



Strategies for Communicating across Diverse Personalities

Practice Active Listening:

- Focus entirely on the speaker without interrupting. Watch for nonverbal cues like tone and body language to understand their true meaning

Tailor Your Tone and Pace:

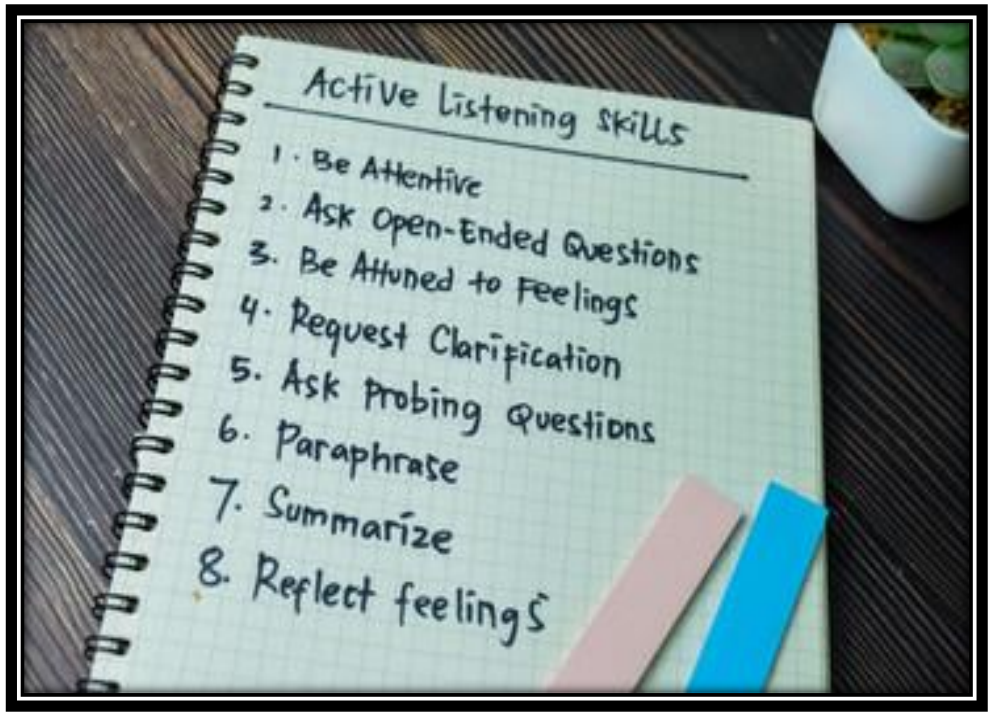
- Match your communication speed and directness to the comfort level of the person you are talking to.

Ask Open-Ended Questions:

- Use questions starting with "what" or "how" to let people elaborate in a way that feels natural to them.

Build Emotional Intelligence:

- Be mindful of how your words affect others. Check your own personal biases before judging a different style of expression



Communication Preferences and Work Styles

The Driver / Driven:
- Be concise
- Focus on outcomes
- Avoid Excessive Detail

The Amiable:
- Build Rapport
- Show Empathy
- Encourage Participation



The Analytical
- Facts and Evidence
- Allow time to process information
- Be organised

The Expressive:
- Focus on possibilities
- Encourage ideas
- Keep the communication engaging



Communication, Motivation and the ERG Theory

Communication, Human Needs and Motivation

Human behaviour and workplace motivation are driven by three acquired needs: achievement, affiliation, and power:

Need for Achievement:

- The drive to excel, achieve success against a set of standards, and tackle moderately challenging goals.

Need for Affiliation:

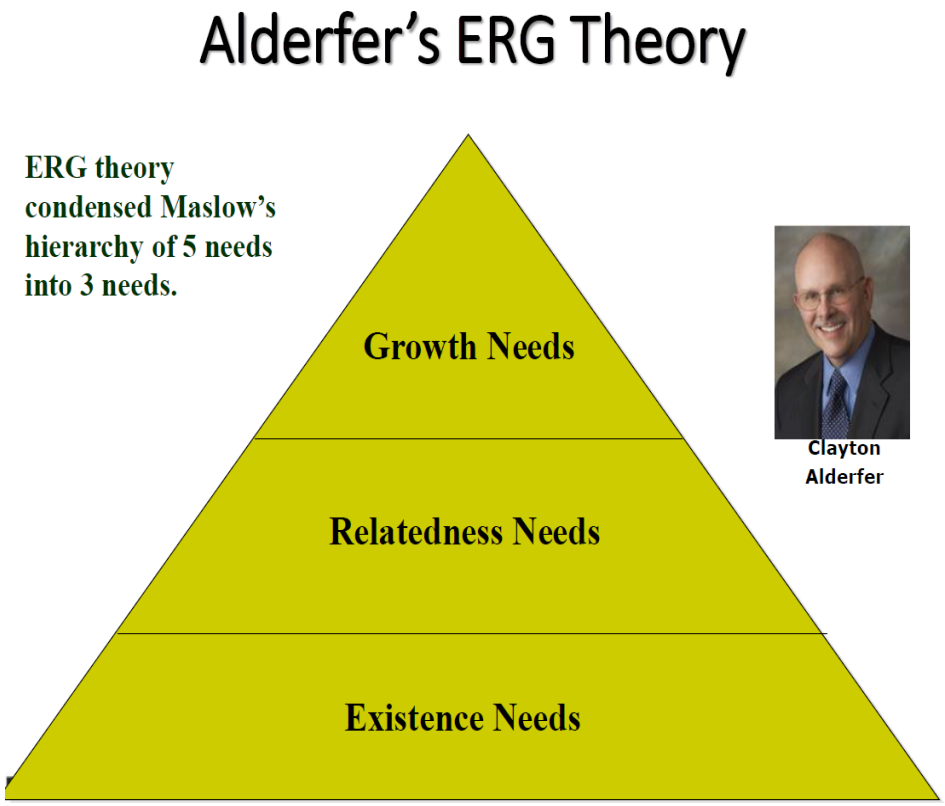
- The desire for friendly, close interpersonal relationships and social acceptance

Need for Power:

- The desire to influence, lead, and make others behave in a way they would not have otherwise



Alderfer's – Existence, Growth and Relatedness Theory



- ERG Theory (existence, relatedness, growth)
- Synthesises Maslow
- Belief that humans have ***existence needs*** and ***growth needs***
- The relatedness needs are ***different for all persons*** but assist in the sliding scale between existence and growth
- We continually move along the sliding scale between existence and growth based on motivation and need requirements



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Thank you!

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Have a 15-minute break



Communication Games: Developing Your Communication Style



Activity: Extrovert -v- Introvert

Customising Your Communication Style For Diverse Personalities

Do you think you are a Good Communicator?

In this activity, you will observe and critique the differences between ***Extroverts and Introverts***.

Extroverts:

- I want you to discuss the organisation of a company picnic. What date, time, and where should you hold this picnic? Is there a theme? What type of catering will you require, and what activities will you do at the picnic

Introverts:

- I want you to discuss the organisation of a company family day. What date, time, and where should you hold this family day? Is there a theme? What type of catering will you require, and what activities will you do at the family day?



Common Manager – Staff Conversations at Zalo?

1. Performance and ownership: A team member is capable but is not taking enough ownership or needs to be more proactive. The manager needs to give constructive feedback while keeping the employee motivated.

2. Different working styles/personality conflicts: Two colleagues have different communication or working styles, leading to tension. The manager needs to mediate without taking sides and help them find a way to work effectively together.

3. Promotion and perceived fairness: A strong employee is disappointed after being passed over for a promotion and feels that their contribution has not been recognised. The manager needs to explain the decision without damaging motivation, while also being honest about what the employee needs to improve.



Role Play Scenario 1: Encouraging Ownership and Proactivity

Context: A capable team member consistently delivers acceptable work but rarely takes initiative. They wait for instructions, avoid making decisions independently, and sometimes miss opportunities to add value. The manager wants to address this constructively, reinforcing strengths while motivating the employee to step up.

Characters

- **Manager (Ninh):** Calm, supportive, focused on development. Wants to empower the employee.
- **Team Member (Quang):** Skilled and reliable but hesitant to take ownership. Prefers clear direction and avoids risks.



Scenario Setup

Ninh has scheduled a one-on-one meeting with Quang after noticing several recent situations where he could have taken initiative, such as waiting for approval on small decisions or not anticipating next steps in a project.

The Goal:

- Give clear, actionable feedback
- Reinforce Quang's strengths
- Motivate Quang to be more proactive
- Maintain trust and psychological safety



Role Play Scenario 1: Encouraging Ownership and Proactivity

- What language/tone helped maintain motivation?
- What made the feedback clear and actionable?
- How did the manager balance support with accountability?

Role Play Scenario 2: Mediating Different Working Styles

Context

Two competent colleagues have increasingly tense interactions because of their different communication and working styles. One prefers fast decisions and direct communication; the other prefers thoughtful analysis and written clarity. Their friction is slowing down collaboration and affecting team morale.

The manager must mediate the conversation, stay neutral, and guide them toward shared expectations and a healthier working dynamic.

Characters

- **Manager (Trung):** Not experienced, attempts to remain neutral, but focused on solutions.
- **Colleague 1 (Ngan):** Fast-paced, direct, prefers quick decisions and verbal communication.
- **Colleague 2 (Thu):** Thoughtful, detail-oriented, prefers written communication and time to process.



Scenario Setup

The manager has invited Ngan and Thu to a joint meeting after noticing tension in project discussions and receiving feedback from both individuals. The goal is not to assign blame but to help them understand each other's styles and agree on practical ways to collaborate more effectively.

The Goal:

- Improve mutual understanding of what each person values, what triggers frustration and how their styles complement each other
- How they will communicate and make decisions that benefit the organisation and each other

Role Play Scenario 2: Mediating Different Working Styles

- How did the manager stay neutral?
- What techniques helped reduce tension?
- How did the manager turn differences into actionable agreements?



Role Play Scenario 3: Managing Disappointment / Missed Promotion

Context

A high-performing employee expected to be promoted and is disappointed after learning that another colleague was selected. They feel their contributions have not been fully recognised.

Characters

- **Manager (Giang):** Empathetic, transparent, focused on development and retention.
- **Employee (Trang):** Strong performer, ambitious, frustrated about being passed over.



Scenario Setup

Giang has invited Trang for a private conversation after noticing her disengagement following the promotion announcement. Trang has been a consistent top performer and was considered for the role, but another candidate was selected due to broader leadership readiness.

The Goal:

- Acknowledge the employee's feelings
- Explain the decision transparently
- Reinforce the employee's value
- Provide clear development guidance
- Maintain motivation and engagement



Role Play Scenario 3: Managing Disappointment / Missed Promotion

- What language helped maintain motivation?
- How did the manager avoid taking a defensive stance?
- How was the development plan framed as an opportunity rather than a correction?

KEY TO GOOD COMMUNICATION: LISTENING & SPEAKING









Effective Manager-to-Employee communication requires
active listening, transparency, and clear expectations.



Practice active listening: Give your full attention during one-on-ones, avoid interrupting, and paraphrase what your employee says to ensure mutual understanding



Set clear expectations: Define the specific goal and desired outcome rather than just assigning a task, and clarify decision-making authority.



Be transparent and provide context: Explain the "why" behind decisions and company changes so employees understand how their work fits the larger strategy









Regular one-on-ones: Have consistent, confidential check-ins focused on professional growth, coaching, and two-way feedback and don't micromanage.



Foster psychological safety: Create an environment where employees feel secure sharing honest thoughts, admitting mistakes, or asking questions without fear of negative judgement



People forget words, but ***they never forget how you made them feel***. Leadership / Management is ***NOT learnt instantly.*** It is a journey and different for everyone. ***It requires practice and thought EVERY DAY.***